

If you don't see your new card in the list for Sound Playback, it might not have been properly installed. You can check this in the *Device Manager*. To get to it, go to the Control Panel and open the System dialog. Under the Hardware tab, click on the Device Manager button. In the Device Manager, look under "Sound, Video and game controllers". If your card isn't listed here, you will need to manually install it using the Add Hardware utility in the Control Panel. If the utility fails to detect your soundcard, you might need to open up your cabinet and make sure that (a) Both, the card and the PCI slot are clean, and (b) the card is connected firmly.



The Device Manager

Tip

If you're going to use an external sound card, disable the on-board card through the BIOS. Press the [Delete] button as soon as your system boots up to enter the BIOS. Go to the Integrated Peripherals section and change the setting for the on-board audio card to Disabled.

If your card does show up in the Device Manager, but has a big, yellow Exclamation Mark next to it, it means that the sound card's drivers weren't properly installed. Make sure you get the latest drivers from the manufacturer's Web site and install them.

Codec Woes

If your PC falls silent when you try to play a particular file type, it simply means the appropriate codec (Compressor-decompressor) hasn't been installed. Invariably, your media player will tell you so. All you have to do then is install the codec, and everything should be back to normal.